



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Customer Relations

PRINCIPLES OF HOSPITALITY AND TOURISM EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- “The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation.”
- “You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge).”
- “You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event.”
- “Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event.”

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of positive customer relations.
2. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
3. Reinforce service orientation through communication.
4. Identify the company's brand promise.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the customer relations manager at QUICKBITES, a fast-casual restaurant chain. QUICKBITES offers a variety of fresh, made-to-order meals in a fast-paced environment. The company's goal is to provide high-quality food with minimal wait times, and it primarily serves office workers and young professionals looking for quick lunch options. QUICKBITES also has a mobile app that allows customers to order ahead, track rewards, and participate in a loyalty program.

However, recent feedback from customers has highlighted some issues with the loyalty program. Many customers have expressed frustration that the rewards are not enticing enough, and some have even mentioned that they feel the app is difficult to use, leading them to order from competitors.

The owner (judge) wants you to present ideas on how to improve the loyalty program and increase customer retention. Your task is to:

- Identify at least two ways the loyalty program can offer more value to customers.
- Propose changes to the app's functionality or user interface that could enhance customer satisfaction.
- Consider any partnerships or promotions that QUICKBITES can implement to boost engagement.

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) in a role-play that takes place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How did you ensure that the changes you proposed to the loyalty program would address the specific concerns raised by the customers, such as the lack of enticing rewards?
2. What data or customer feedback would you recommend using to measure the success of the loyalty program improvements and the changes to the mobile app?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of positive customer relations.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Demonstrate a customer service mindset.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Reinforce service orientation through communication.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Identify the company's brand promise.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
5.	Unique Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	Practical Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Effective Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
8.	Critical Thinking Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	Communication Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Decision Making Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
11.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
TOTAL SCORE						